CASE STUDY

the crime is, how it typically happens (step-by-step), who is what usually targeted, and what the consequences are

Rohit is a first-year engineering student who had recently started using UPI apps for small daily payments like food, mobile recharges, and online shopping. One day, he received a call from someone who claimed to be a bank customer care executive. The person spoke very professionally and told Rohit that there was a problem with his UPI account and it might get blocked if he didn't verify it immediately.

Since Rohit was not very experienced with these things, he got a bit worried and decided to follow the instructions. The caller sent him a link through SMS, which looked like a real bank website. Rohit opened it and entered some basic details. After that, he received a "collect request" on his UPI app. The caller told him that this was just for verification and no money would be deducted.

Without thinking much, Rohit accepted the request. Within a few seconds, money was deducted from his account. When he tried calling the number again, it was switched off. That's when he realized that he had been scammed.

This type of fraud usually happens when scammers create panic and trick people into trusting them. Students and elderly people are common targets because they may not be fully aware of such scams. The main consequence is financial loss, but it also creates stress and fear. This incident shows how important it is to stay alert and never trust unknown calls or links while using UPI.